

Be Prepared for Disasters with Open Source Software



Disaster may strike anytime, anywhere. And when it does, all is lost for those who are not prepared for it. Disaster preparedness and recovery are basic elements of a well-run enterprise plan, especially one that is based on IT. In this article, the author shows how disaster recovery is different from a mere backup, and highlights a few FOSS disaster recovery tools.

Disaster recovery (DR) is about preparing for and recovering from a disaster. Any event that has a negative impact on a company's business continuity or finances could be termed a disaster. This includes hardware or software failure, a network outage, a power outage, physical damage to a building like fire or floods, human error or some other significant event. To minimise the impact of a

disaster, companies invest time and resources to plan and prepare for it, to train employees, and to document and update processes.

There are a few common industry terms related to disaster planning.

- **Recovery time objective (RTO)** is the time it takes after a disruption to restore a business process to its service level, as defined by the operational level agreement (OLA). For example, if a disaster

occurs at 12:00 p.m. (noon) and the RTO is eight hours, the DR process should restore the business process to the acceptable service level by 8:00 p.m.

- **Recovery point objective (RPO)** refers to the acceptable amount of data loss measured in time. For example, if a disaster occurs at 12:00 p.m. (noon) and the RPO is one hour, the system should recover all data that was in the system